

Katharine Bierwagen

Santa Barbara, California | kate.bierwagen@gmail.com | (650) 474-1554

EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Barbara

Bachelor of Science (B.S.) Environmental Studies

Cumulative GPA: 3.50

Relevant Coursework: Environmental Restoration Skills, GIS for Environmental Applications, Water Supply and Demand, Conservation Planning, Statistics for Environmental Studies, Geological Applications of GIS

Santa Barbara, California

Expected June 2027

Wildlands Institute

Field Studies program focused on Himalayan habitats and ecological vulnerabilities in the Manaslu Conservation Region in Nepal

Bellingham, Washington

September 2025 - November 2025

SKILLS & CERTIFICATIONS

- **Data & Analysis Software:** R, ArcGIS Pro, QGIS, Miradi, Github
- **Computer Software:** Google Suite, Microsoft Office
- **Certifications:** Open Water SCUBA (NAUI), Wilderness First Aid, Scientific Diver (AAUS)

EMPLOYMENT EXPERIENCE

Santa Barbara Coastal LTER

Scientific Diving Intern

Santa Barbara, California

April 2026 - Present

- Execute benthic transects and assist with a variety of field sampling protocols to support long-term ecological monitoring of kelp forest ecosystems in the Santa Barbara Channel.

UCSB Adventure Programs

Adventure Ropes Course and Campus Point Ocean Rental Center Staff

Santa Barbara, California

May 2024 - Present

- Facilitate rock climbing and outdoor education for groups of 20 - 40 participants ages 5 - 17, minimizing accident risk through safety briefings and hazard assessment.
- Assess ocean conditions and manage group logistics to ensure safety of all participants and renters.

Caselle Lab

Lab Assistant

Santa Barbara, California

April 2025 - September 2025

- Analyzed underwater video footage to identify, count, and measure fish species, generating quantitative datasets to assess effectiveness of Santa Barbara Marine Protected Areas (MPAs).
- Assisted with fish dissections for the California Collaborative Fisheries Research Program, gathering biological data to inform statewide fisheries management.

Recreational Equipment Inc.

Sales Associate

San Carlos, California

March 2021 - September 2024

- Advised customers on outdoor gear selection, delivering personalized service to drive satisfaction.

LearningTech.org

Administrative Aide

San Carlos, California

September 2021 - September 2022

- Maintained organized digital records and managed daily financial transactions, ensuring accuracy and efficiency across administrative operations.

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

UCSB Adventure Programs

Trip Leader

Santa Barbara, California

May 2024 - Present

- Lead groups of 10 - 20 participants camping, canoeing, kayaking, and backpacking.
- Collaborate with co-leaders to assess risks, ensure participant safety, and teach vital outdoor skills.

Pacific Northwest Backpacking Expedition

National Outdoor Leadership School

Lander, Wyoming

June 2021 - July 2021

- Month-long leadership backpacking course through Northwest Washington, emphasizing wilderness skills.